Pierce C. Johnson

Department of Psychology
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EDUCATION

2022 B.A., Psychology & Philosophy, *magna cum laude*, Elon University

Thesis: *Impression updating: The role of change detection and recollection in associative memory for face-adjective pairs*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2026-27 Instructor, Department of Psychology, University at Albany

Statistical Methods for Psychology, 2 sections

Psychopathology, 1 section

2023-26 Teaching Assistant (Grader), Department of Psychology, University at Albany

Statistical Methods for Psychology, 7 sections

Introduction to Psychology, 1 section

Personality Psychology, 2 sections

STUDENT MENTORSHIP

2026-27 William Duke, Independent Undergraduate Research Assistant

Project: *Perceptions of Suicidality and Implications for Decision Making*

2024-26 Malcolm Nance, Independent Undergraduate Research Assistant

Project: *The Role of Music in Social Impression Formation*

Endowed Undergraduate Research Award, University at Albany, $1,000

2025-26 Ella Bremmer, Independent Undergraduate Research Assistant

Project: *The Effects of Mindfulness and Attention on Life Satisfaction*

2023-25 Priya Samaroo, Independent Undergraduate Research Assistant

Project: *Integrating Memory Across Experiences*

2023-25 Sam Wang, Independent Study Research Assistant

Project: *Memory and Motivation: Comparing Intrinsic and Extrinsic Factors*

PUBLICATIONS

Conference Proceedings

Johnson, P. C., Cox, G. E., & Friedman, R. S. (2024, Apr. 26). Turn the beat around: How melodic predictability informs aesthetic preference formation. *Third SUNY Graduate Research Conference Proceedings 3*, 65.

Manuscripts Under Review

Johnson, P. C., Cox, G. E., & Friedman, R. S. (2026). *Revisiting Huron's "Prediction Effect": Does prediction, anticipation, or mere exposure promote music preference?*. Manuscript submitted for publication.

Manuscripts in Preparation

Johnson, P. C., & Cox, G. E. (2026). *That's about the shape of it: A scaling study of similarity in a generated melody set*. Department of Psychology, University at Albany, State University of New York.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

***** Mentored undergraduate co-author

Johnson, P. C., & Mobley, F. (2026, Jul. 17-21). *Auditory classification decisions: Modeling evidence accumulation for signals in naturalistic environments* [Poster]. 59th Annual Meeting of the Society for Mathematical Psychology, Montreal, QC, Canada.

Johnson, P. C., & Cox, G. E. (2025, Oct. 24). *Perceptual similarity and preference: The features that matter during music listening* [Poster]. 64th Annual Meeting of the New England Psychological Association, Newton, MA, United States.

Johnson, P. C., & Cox, G. E. (2025, Jul. 25-29). *Statistical learning: The role of implicit structures and their influence on memory and preference for melodies over the time-course of learning* [Poster]. 58th Annual Meeting of the Society for Mathematical Psychology, Columbus, OH, United States.

Watson, J., Charbonneau, B., **Johnson, P. C.**, & Hutchison, K. (2024, Nov. 21-24). *Images of nature elicit less mind wandering than images of urban settings* [Poster]. Psychonomic Society 65th Annual Meeting, New York, NY, United States.

Johnson, P. C., Cox, G. E., & Friedman, R. S. (2024, Nov. 21). *Statistical learning: How contingent regularities influence learning, memory and preference for melodic pairs over the time-course of learning* [Poster]. 23rd Annual Auditory Perception, Cognition, and Action Meeting, New York, NY, United States.

Johnson, P. C., Cox, G. E., & Friedman, R. S. (2024, Nov. 21-24). *Statistical learning: How contingent regularities influence memory and preference for melodic pairs presented in a continuous stream* [Poster]. Psychonomic Society 65th Annual Meeting, New York, NY, United States.

*****Samaroo, S., Gillespie N. F., **Johnson, P. C.**, & Cox, G. E. (2024, Oct. 26). *Integrating memory across experiences* [Poster]. 63rd Annual Meeting of the New England Psychological Association, Springfield, MA, United States.

Johnson, P. C., Cox, G. E., & Friedman, R. S. (2024, May 30-31). *Turn the beat around: How melodic predictability informs aesthetic preference formation* [Poster]. Context and Episodic Memory Symposium, Philadelphia, PA, United States.

Johnson, P. C., Cox, G., & Friedman, R. (2024, April 26). *Turn the beat around: How melodic predictability informs aesthetic preference formation* [Poster]. SUNY Graduate Research Conference, virtual.

Watson, J., Charbonneau, B., Towner, C., **Johnson, P. C.**, Hood, A., & Hutchison, K. (2023, Nov. 16-19). *Developing a normative database of the psychological effects of nature and urban images* [Talk]. Psychonomic Society 64th Annual Meeting, San Francisco, CA, United States.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2025 Repperger Summer Intern, Cognitive Models Branch, Air Force Research Lab

2022-23 Lab Manager, Department of Psychology, University of Colorado, Denver

GRANTS

2026 Professional Development Grant, Graduate Student Association, University at Albany, $320

2025 Professional Development Grant, Graduate Student Association, University at Albany, $650

AWARDS

2023 Semi-finalist, Fulbright Student Program

Recommended for Open Study/Research grant to Aarhus University, Denmark

2022 Member, Phi Beta Kappa

DEPARTMENTAL PRESENTATIONS

Johnson, P. C., Cox, G. E., & Friedman, R. S. (2026, Apr. 10). *Predictability and learning of contingencies in music: Implications for preference* [Talk]. Topics in Cognitive Psychology Seminar Series, Albany, NY, United States.

*****Bremmer, E., & **Johnson, P. C.** (2025, Oct. 27). *Mindfulness and attention: A study of the influence of well-being on cognitive functioning* [Talk]. Current Research in Psychology Colloquium Series, Albany, NY, United States.

*****Nance, M., **Johnson, P. C.**, & Cox, G. E. (2025, Apr. 30). *What's good?: The influence of album art on social impression formation* [Poster]. 3rd Annual UAlbany Research Showcase, Albany, NY, United States.

Johnson, P. C., & Cox, G. E. (2025, Apr. 30). *One of these things is not like the other: Musical pairwise similarity rating and features of auditory salience* [Poster]. 3rd Annual UAlbany Research Showcase, Albany, NY, United States.

Johnson, P. C., Cox, G. E., & Friedman, R. S. (2025, Apr. 11). *Similarity of random melodies: An MDS study of human-perceived acoustic features in the formation of preference and memory judgments* [Talk]. Topics in Cognitive Psychology Seminar Series, Albany, NY, United States.

Johnson, P. C., Cox, G. E., & Friedman, R. S. (2024, Nov. 8). *Statistical learning: How contingent regularities influence learning, memory, and preference for melody pairs over the time course of learning* [Poster]. Topics in Cognitive Psychology Seminar Series, Albany, NY, United States.

Johnson, P. C. (2024, Nov. 1). *Music cognition: The interaction between memory, predictability, and preference* [Talk]. Current Research in Psychology Colloquium Series, Albany, NY, United States.

Johnson, P. C. (2024, Oct. 18). *Demonstrating features of jspsych: A flexible approach to online study administration* [Talk]. Topics in Cognitive Psychology Seminar Series, Albany, NY, United States.

*****Samaroo, S., Gillespie N. F., **Johnson, P. C.**, & Cox, G. E., (2024, Apr. 30). *The art of memory and colorful distortion* [Poster]. 2nd Annual UAlbany Research Showcase, Albany, NY, United States.

Johnson, P. C., Cox, G. E., & Friedman, R. S. (2024, Apr. 12). *Turn the beat around: Development of novel random melodies for studies of memory and prediction* [Poster]. Topics in Cognitive Psychology Seminar Series, Albany, NY, United States.

PROFESSIONAL, UNIVERSITY, AND DEPARTMENTAL SERVICE

2025- Organizing Committee, Cognitive Seminar Speaker Series, Department of Psychology, University at Albany

2024-25 Grant Reviewer, Graduate Student Association, University at Albany

2023-25 Mentor, Department of Psychology, University at Albany Undergraduate Mentor Program

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Society for Mathematical Psychology

Auditory Perception & Cognition Society

Psychonomic Society